

BrewBot Kiosk

Fresh-ground, barista-quality coffee in 30 seconds — one machine that sells while you sleep.

What It Is

BrewBot is a self-operating coffee kiosk that grinds whole beans, brews, and serves a fresh cup in about 30 seconds with zero staff and zero mistakes. The customer chooses a drink on the touchscreen, taps to pay, and collects it — espresso, latte, or americano, all automated. It runs 24/7 in high-footfall locations, turning a single square meter of floor space into a round-the-clock coffee shop without a barista.

How It Makes Money

You own the machine and sell coffee directly to commuters and passers-by at \$3–\$4.50 a cup. Buyers are caffeine-driven foot traffic: airport travelers, office workers, students, and shoppers who want speed over a sit-down café. Income is cups sold x price minus bean, milk, and cup cost. Scale by operating a fleet of machines across multiple sites, and later by selling or leasing branded machines to other operators.

Startup Costs

- **The machine (Alibaba / China sourcing):** Automatic self-serve bean-to-cup coffee vending kiosks from Guangdong/Shanghai suppliers run **\$5,000–\$13,000 per unit** FOB. Search "automatic coffee vending machine fresh bean" — MOQ typically 1.
- **Sea freight + import duty to US:** **\$700–\$1,400** per machine.
- **Customs, broker, install:** **\$300–\$600**.
- **Initial inventory** (beans, milk powder/UHT, cups, lids, syrups, sugar): **\$400–\$700**.
- **Location placement rent:** **\$400–\$1,500/month** (airports and premium malls cost more).
- **Permits, LLC, insurance, water/filtration hookup:** **\$600–\$1,800**.
- **Realistic all-in to launch one machine:** **\$8,000–\$17,000**.

The Numbers

- Ingredient cost per cup (beans, milk, cup, lid, sugar): **~\$0.45**
- Sell price: **\$3.50** (blended average)
- Card processing + electricity per cup: **~\$0.25**
- **Profit per cup: ~\$2.80**
- At a realistic **90 cups/day** (not the hype-implied 170+): $90 \times \$2.80 =$ **\$252/day**, or **~\$7,560/month** per machine before rent.
- Subtract location rent (~~\$800~~) and restock/maintenance labor (~~\$600~~): **net ~\$6,100/month per machine**.
- The viral "\$18,000/month" claim assumes a premium airport spot at ~170 cups/day and high pricing — possible at a flagship site, but plan around \$6K net per machine.

How To Start

1. **Order one sample bean-to-cup kiosk** from a vetted Alibaba supplier via Trade Assurance; require a working-unit video and a 12-month parts warranty.

2. **Form an LLC**, get liability insurance, and pull your local food/beverage vending permit.
3. **Secure a high-traffic placement** — airport concourse, hospital, large office lobby, or university — on a flat-rent or 12–18% revenue-share deal.
4. **Confirm power and a clean water line or plan a sealed water-tank model** for the location.
5. **Source beans and milk** from a wholesale roaster/Costco Business, then dial in recipes and pricing on the screen.
6. **Enable card, Apple Pay, and a loyalty QR**, stock it, and go live.
7. **Run 30 days of data, optimize the menu and price, then reinvest into machine #2.**

Where To Get Customers

Rent foot traffic instead of chasing customers. Best sites: airports, train/bus stations, hospitals, large office buildings, gyms, universities, and 24-hour shopping centers. Boost with a Google Business listing per location, TikTok/Instagram clips of the 30-second pour, a loyalty "buy 9 get 1 free" QR, and clear pricing signage at eye level.

Pro Tips

- **Placement is everything — chase captive, time-pressured traffic** (airports, hospitals, offices) where people will pay a premium for speed over a café queue.
- **Negotiate revenue-share for your first site** so you're not stuck paying flat rent on an unproven location.
- **Use UHT or quality milk powder and a self-cleaning brew group** to cut spoilage and service calls — uptime and consistency are what turn a kiosk into a cash machine.